

Pro Interview Packet

Screening interview for independent pros (1099 businesses): the process, what never to ask, the questions with what a good answer has, the scoring guide, a scoring sheet and the approval checklist.

Candidate

Business

Trades

Phone / email

Interviewer

Date

How to run the interview (about 20–30 minutes)

1. Introduce yourself and Handled; explain it's a short conversation about their work, and that they'll hear back within 2 business days.
2. Ask the **core questions** (section 3), then **2–4 questions for their trades** (section 4). Use your own words; one follow-up if an answer is vague.
3. Write down what they actually say — those notes are your evidence for each score.
4. Leave time for their questions. Don't promise approval.
5. Score right after (sections 5–6), then enter it in the Hub.

The same questions are used everywhere. The AI interviewer, the Hub scorecard (Hub → Recruiting → the candidate → “Interview them myself”) and this packet all come from one list, so every candidate is judged the same way. A person makes every decision. Enter your scores in the Hub afterwards so they're on the candidate's record.

1. How a pro gets approved

1. **Applies** at /pros. An AI screen of their business qualifications.
2. **Screening interview**: the AI interviewer (a private link by email, about 15 minutes, English or Spanish), or you, in person or by phone, with this packet.
3. **A person decides**: invite to set up · follow up first · not now.
4. **Setup in the pro portal**: W-9 · independent contractor agreement · specialties · work area & days · insurance certificate (general liability, plus coverages their trade needs) · workers' comp or a no-employees statement · trade license where required · photo ID check · background check (consent through the screening provider) · payout method.
5. Documents verified and background check clear → **approved to receive job offers**.
6. **First jobs are probation**: smaller jobs, a human review of each, and a call to the customer.

Wording. Pros run their own businesses. Say **“approved”**, not “hired”. They choose their jobs, days, area, methods and tools. Don't promise a number of jobs or an income; any pay figure before approval is an estimate.

2. Never ask about

- | | |
|---|--|
| • ✗ Age or date of birth
Edad o fecha de nacimiento | • ✗ Height, weight or genetic information
Estatura, peso o información genética |
| • ✗ Race, color, ethnicity, national origin, birthplace or accent
Raza, color, etnia, origen nacional, lugar de nacimiento o acento | • ✗ Arrests or criminal history (the background check handles this, with notice and a chance to respond)
Arrestos o antecedentes penales (la verificación de antecedentes se encarga de esto, con aviso y oportunidad de responder) |
| • ✗ Citizenship or immigration status
Ciudadanía o estatus migratorio | • ✗ Military discharge type
Tipo de baja militar |
| • ✗ Religion or religious holidays
Religión o días religiosos | • ✗ Credit, debts, bankruptcy, or past pay
Crédito, deudas, bancarrota o pagos anteriores |
| • ✗ Sex, gender identity, sexual orientation
Sexo, identidad de género, orientación sexual | • ✗ Union membership or political views
Afiliación sindical u opiniones políticas |
| • ✗ Marriage, pregnancy, children or childcare
Matrimonio, embarazo, hijos o cuidado de niños | • ✗ Language ability beyond what the job needs (we work in English and Spanish)
Habilidad con idiomas más allá de lo que el trabajo requiere (trabajamos en inglés y español) |
| • ✗ Disability, health, medical history, medications, workers' comp claims
Discapacidad, salud, historial médico, medicamentos, reclamos de compensación laboral | |

If a candidate brings one of these up, don't follow up and don't let it affect the decision. Ask everyone the same core questions. Score **what they said**, not accent, grammar or which language they use. If someone asks for an accommodation (more time, a phone interview, an interpreter), say yes.

3. Questions for everyone

1

Tell me about your business and the work you do most.

Skill & experience

Cuénteme sobre su negocio y el trabajo que hace con más frecuencia.

Look for: Specific services, who their customers are, how long they've done it.

2

How long have you done this work, and how did you learn it?

Skill & experience

¿Cuánto tiempo lleva haciendo este trabajo y cómo lo aprendió?

Look for: Years and real examples; apprenticeships, past companies or family business all count.

3

Describe a recent job you're proud of. What made it good?

Quality standards

Describe un trabajo reciente del que esté orgulloso. ¿Qué lo hizo bueno?

Look for: Concrete details; talks about the result for the customer, not just speed.

4

Before you call a job done, how do you check your own work?

Quality standards

Antes de dar un trabajo por terminado, ¿cómo revisa su propio trabajo?

Look for: A walkthrough, photos, a list — some habit of checking. **Red flag:** "I just know" / no habit of checking.

5

Tell me about a time a customer wasn't happy with the work. What did you do?

Customer communication

Cuénteme de una vez que un cliente no quedó contento con el trabajo. ¿Qué hizo?

Look for: Listened, fixed it, kept calm; owns mistakes. **Red flag:** Blames the customer, argues, or walks away.

6

You're going to be 30 minutes late to a job. What do you do?

Reliability

Va a llegar 30 minutos tarde a un trabajo. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Tells the customer before the window starts, gives a real ETA. **Red flag:** Doesn't tell anyone, or thinks lateness is normal.

7

Which areas and days do you want jobs in, and how many jobs a day can you do well?

Reliability

¿En qué zonas y días quiere trabajos, y cuántos trabajos al día puede hacer bien?

Look for: Realistic capacity; knows their own limits. (They set this themselves.)

8

What would make you cancel a job you'd already accepted, and how would you handle it?

Reliability

¿Qué haría que cancelara un trabajo que ya aceptó, y cómo lo manejaría?

Look for: Only real emergencies; gives as much notice as possible. **Red flag:** Would drop a job for a better-paying one.

9

At a job, the customer asks you to "just do one more thing" that wasn't booked. What do you do?

Customer communication

En un trabajo, el cliente le pide que "haga una cosa más" que no estaba reservada. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Explains it's extra and sends a change order through the app before doing it. **Red flag:** Does it off the books for cash.

10

A customer offers you cash to come back next month without Handled. What do you say?

Business readiness

Un cliente le ofrece efectivo para regresar el próximo mes sin Handled. ¿Qué le dice?

Look for: Declines politely and keeps it on the app (their agreement has a 12-month non-solicit). **Red flag:** Would take the cash job.

11

How do you protect a customer's home and belongings while you work?

Safety & property care

*¿Cómo protege la casa y las pertenencias del cliente mientras trabaja?***Look for:** Covers floors, moves things carefully, asks before touching valuables.

12

You find something unsafe at a job — exposed wires, mold, a ladder or roof you don't trust. What do you do?

Safety & property care

*Encuentra algo inseguro en un trabajo: cables expuestos, moho, una escalera o techo que no le da confianza. ¿Qué hace?***Look for:** Stops that part, tells the customer and us, doesn't work beyond their license. **Red flag:** Pushes through anyway.

13

Our jobs use a phone app: you accept offers, follow a checklist and upload before-and-after photos. How comfortable are you with that?

Business readiness

*Nuestros trabajos usan una app: acepta ofertas, sigue una lista y sube fotos de antes y después. ¿Qué tan cómodo se siente con eso?***Look for:** Uses a smartphone daily, or has someone on their team who does.

14

Do you carry general liability insurance today? If not, are you willing to get it before your first job?

Business readiness

*¿Tiene hoy un seguro de responsabilidad civil general? Si no, ¿está dispuesto a obtenerlo antes de su primer trabajo?***Look for:** Yes, or a clear yes to getting it (we help with quotes). **Red flag:** Won't carry insurance.

15

What tools, equipment and transportation do you bring to a job?

Business readiness

*¿Qué herramientas, equipo y transporte lleva a un trabajo?***Look for:** Own tools and a way to get to jobs (and haul, if their trade needs it).

16

Do you work alone or with a crew? If you have helpers, who pays them and covers their insurance?

Business readiness

¿Trabaja solo o con un equipo? Si tiene ayudantes, ¿quién les paga y cubre su seguro?

Look for: Clear: their business pays and covers its own crew (workers' comp when they have employees).

17

What questions do you have for us?

not scored

¿Qué preguntas tiene para nosotros?

Look for: Not scored. Good questions about how offers, pay and support work are a plus.

4. Questions by trade — ask the ones for the candidate's trades

Cleaning · windows · carpet · organizing · car detailing

C1 Walk me through how a deep clean of a bathroom differs from a standard clean.

Skill & experience

Explíqueme en qué se diferencia una limpieza profunda de un baño de una limpieza estándar.

Look for: Grout, glass and tracks, fixtures, baseboards, vents — and the time it takes.

C2 Which products or methods do you avoid on natural stone, hardwood or stainless steel?

Safety & property care

¿Qué productos o métodos evita en piedra natural, madera o acero inoxidable?

Look for: Knows acids/abrasives damage stone and finishes; tests in a hidden spot.

Handyman · remodeling · low voltage

R1 A door sticks and won't latch. How do you figure out what's wrong?

Skill & experience

Una puerta se atora y no cierra. ¿Cómo averigua qué está mal?

Look for: Checks hinges and screws, strike plate, frame / settling — before planing.

R2 When do you tell a customer a job needs a licensed electrician or plumber instead of you?

Safety & property care

¿Cuándo le dice a un cliente que un trabajo necesita un electricista o plomero con licencia en lugar de usted?

Look for: Knows the line: new circuits, gas, main lines, permits. **Red flag:** Would do licensed work without a license.

Lawn · trees · snow · gutters · pressure washing · pet waste

O1 How do you make a yard look finished when you leave?

Quality standards

¿Cómo deja un jardín con aspecto de terminado al irse?

Look for: Edging, trimming around obstacles, blowing walks and drive, clippings off the street.

O2 How do you keep rocks and debris from hitting cars, windows and people?

Safety & property care

¿Cómo evita que piedras y desechos golpeen autos, ventanas y personas?

Look for: Walks the yard first, discharge direction, stops when people pass.

Hauling · moving · containers

M1 How do you move a heavy dresser down a flight of stairs safely?

Safety & property care

¿Cómo baja un tocador pesado por una escalera de forma segura?

Look for: Empty it, two people, straps/dolly, the strong person below, protect walls and floors.

M2 You scratch a customer's floor while moving furniture. What do you do?

Customer communication

Raya el piso de un cliente al mover un mueble. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Tells the customer right away, photos, reports it — never hides it. **Red flag:** Hides it.

Painting

P1 What prep do you do before painting a room?

Skill & experience

¿Qué preparación hace antes de pintar un cuarto?

Look for: Move/cover furniture and floors, patch, sand, clean, tape or cut in, prime where needed.

P2

What changes when the home was built before 1978?

Safety & property care

¿Qué cambia cuando la casa fue construida antes de 1978?

Look for: Lead paint: EPA RRP certified firm, containment, no dry sanding.

Plumbing · electrical · HVAC

L1

Which licenses do you hold, in which city or state, and when do they expire?

Business readiness

¿Qué licencias tiene, en qué ciudad o estado, y cuándo vencen?

Look for: Specific license types and numbers they can provide for verification.

L2

When do you pull a permit, and how do you handle inspections?

Safety & property care

¿Cuándo saca un permiso y cómo maneja las inspecciones?

Look for: Knows local rules; schedules inspections; doesn't skip them. **Red flag:** Avoids permits.

Pet care

P1

A dog slips out of its harness on a walk. What do you do?

Safety & property care

Un perro se zafa del arnés en un paseo. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Stays calm, doesn't chase into traffic, calls the owner and us right away.

P2

During a visit, a pet seems sick. What do you do?

Customer communication

Durante una visita, una mascota parece enferma. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Calls the owner, follows their vet instructions, documents it.

Transportation

T1

Who is the licensed operator for your vehicles, and what licenses and endorsements do your drivers hold?

Business readiness

¿Quién es el operador con licencia de sus vehículos, y qué licencias y endosos tienen sus conductores?

Look for: Named licensed operator; CDL / chauffeur license as required; commercial auto insurance.

T2

A passenger is intoxicated and getting aggressive. What do you do?

Safety & property care

Un pasajero está ebrio y se pone agresivo. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Stays calm, stops safely, doesn't escalate, calls for help when needed and reports it.

Errands & couriers

E1

How do you prove a delivery was made, and what do you do when nobody's there to receive it?

Quality standards

¿Cómo comprueba que se hizo una entrega y qué hace cuando no hay nadie para recibirla?

Look for: Photo, signature when required, follows instructions, never leaves sensitive items unattended.

Events

E1

On event day you're running late or a piece of equipment fails. What do you do?

Reliability

El día del evento va tarde o falla un equipo. ¿Qué hace?

Look for: Early arrival buffer, backup equipment, tells the planner right away.

Security (licensed agencies)

S1

Which security agency license do you hold, how do you register your guards, and do you provide armed officers?

Business readiness

¿Qué licencia de agencia de seguridad tiene, cómo registra a sus guardias y ofrece oficiales armados?

Look for: Michigan agency license (LARA) they can provide; guards are their employees and registered; armed only with proper authorization. **Red flag:** Individual freelance guards, or no agency license.

S2

A guest who's been drinking gets loud and pushes another guest. Walk me through what your guards do.

Safety & property care

Un invitado que ha estado bebiendo levanta la voz y empuja a otro invitado. Explíqueme qué hacen sus guardias.

Look for: Calm de-escalation first, separate people, involve the host, call police when needed, never more force than the law allows, written incident report. **Red flag:** Goes straight to force, or no incident reporting.

5. Scoring guide (1–5)

Competency	1 — concerning	3 — meets	5 — excellent
Skill & experience Habilidad y experiencia	Vague or no real experience in the trades they chose	Clear, relevant experience; explains how they do common jobs	Deep experience; explains trade-offs and edge cases like a pro
Quality standards Estándares de calidad	"Good enough"; no way of checking their work	Checks their own work; takes photos; fixes misses	Clear personal standard, walkthroughs, owns and fixes issues without being asked
Reliability Confiabilidad	Casual about lateness or cancelling; no plan when things change	Tells the customer early when running late; realistic about capacity	Plans ahead, rarely cancels, has a backup when something goes wrong
Customer communication Comunicación con el cliente	Argues, blames, or would do unpaid / off-app work	Polite, explains clearly, uses change orders for extra work	Calm under pressure, sets expectations, turns complaints into return customers
Safety & property care Seguridad y cuidado de la propiedad	Ignores hazards or would push through unsafe work	Protects floors and belongings; stops when something is unsafe	Proactive about hazards, knows the code / limits of their trade, protects people and property
Business readiness Preparación del negocio	No insurance and unwilling to get it; no tools or transportation	Has or will get insurance; own tools and transportation; can use a phone app	Insured and licensed where needed, set up as a business, comfortable with app, photos and receipts

Result

✓ **Advance (invite)**: average of the six scores ≥ 3.2 and no score below 2.

⌚ **Follow up**: a very low score in one area, or an area you didn't cover — a short call on that topic first.

✗ **Not now**: average under 2.6, or any knockout.

Knockouts: won't carry required insurance · would do licensed work without the license · would knowingly continue unsafe work · abusive or threatening in the interview.

2 and 4 are in between: use them when an answer is better than one description but not quite the next.

6. Scoring sheet

Candidate: _____ Trades: _____ Date: _____

Competency	Score (circle)	Evidence — what they said
Skill & experience	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
Quality standards	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
Reliability	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
Customer communication	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
Safety & property care	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
Business readiness	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
Average		Knockout? ☐ No ☐ Yes: _____

Result

☐ Advance — invite to set up ☐ Follow up first ☐ Not now

Reason / follow-up topic: _____

Overall notes

Interviewer signature: _____ Entered in the Hub ☐

7. Approval checklist

Candidate: _____ Applied: _____

- | | |
|---|------------|
| ☐ Application received | date _____ |
| ☐ Application screened | date _____ |
| ☐ Screening interview done | date _____ |
| ☐ Decision by a person: invite | date _____ |
| ☐ Pro account created (signed in with the application email) | date _____ |
| ☐ W-9 on file | date _____ |
| ☐ Independent contractor agreement signed | date _____ |
| ☐ Specialties chosen | date _____ |
| ☐ Work area & days set | date _____ |
| ☐ Insurance certificate (COI) verified | date _____ |
| ☐ Trade coverages verified (where the trade needs them) | date _____ |
| ☐ Workers' comp, or a no-employees statement | date _____ |
| ☐ Trade license verified (where required) | date _____ |
| ☐ Photo ID verified | date _____ |
| ☐ Background check cleared | date _____ |
| ☐ Payout method set | date _____ |
| ☐ Approved — receiving job offers | date _____ |
| ☐ First job completed and reviewed | date _____ |

The Hub tracks every step for each candidate (Hub → Recruiting → click a name): what's next, whether it waits on the candidate or on us, and a red flag when someone is stuck — 2+ days waiting on our decision or 7+ days with no progress.